

Aalap Shah

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SUMMARY

Cybersecurity engineering student at George Mason University, CompTIA Security+ and A+ certified US citizen with hands-on experience in network security and firewall administration, application security and offensive testing through CTFs, vulnerability assessment and remediation. Applying for: Security Engineer Intern (Summer 2026).

SKILLS

Security & Networking: Vulnerability assessment, Network security, Physical security audits, SIEM monitoring, Incident response, Firewall configuration, Intrusion detection, Patch management, Access control

Frameworks & Compliance: Security policy development, NIST 800-53, ISO 27001, RMF, Risk assessment

Programming & Scripting: Python, C#, PowerShell

Platforms & Tools: Teams, Windows, macOS, Linux, Microsoft 365, Google Suite, Adobe Suite, Zoom, WebEx, GoToMeeting

Soft Skills: Time management, Attention to detail, Written and verbal communication, Cross-functional collaboration, Problem-solving, Documentation

CERTIFICATIONS

- CompTIA Security+ ce
- CompTIA A+ ce
- C-CURE 9000 System Installer/Maintainer
- HUGS Enterprise Infrastructure Deployment - CIE
- HUGS Enterprise MobileView Deployment - Certified Solution Engineer
- Workplace Readiness

EXPERIENCE

Emergency Medical Technician, Arcola Volunteer Fire Department - VA Feb 2026 - Present

- Volunteer EMT within the Loudoun County Combined Fire and Rescue System
- Hold current National and Virginia EMT certifications
- Operational EMS full member responding to emergency calls

Security Professional, QTS Data Centers - Ashburn, VA May 2024 - Present

- Monitor and enforce access control across a Tier III+ data center campus
- Coordinate with facilities, operations, and IT teams to maintain a secure environment
- Conduct systematic audits, inspections, and vulnerability checks on access control mechanisms
- Respond to alerts and anomalies, triaging incidents and escalating per documented playbooks

Network Specialist, Mindboard, Inc. - VA Jun 2025 - Dec 2025

- Helped develop incident response playbooks and contributed to mock incident response drills
- Assisted in monitoring and analyzing network traffic using SIEM tools to detect suspicious activity and potential threats
- Supported the implementation of security controls based on NIST 800-53 and ISO 27001 frameworks
- Helped maintain and update cybersecurity documentation, including security policies, procedures, and risk assessments

Field Service Technician, Tech Systems Inc. - Buford, GA Aug 2023 - Jun 2025

- Provided technical support and resolved issues for enterprise clients

- Served as System Administrator for HUGS, an infant protection system in hospitals, ensuring its functionality and reliability
- Tested systems and troubleshoot to confirm proper operation and validation of computer systems
- Collaborated with a team while balancing 50+ work hours per week with full-time student status
- Responded to service calls promptly, restoring systems to full functionality
- Managed company inventory and resources efficiently
- Demonstrated strong technical expertise in networking, access, and video systems

Network Support Technician, eLaunchers - Germantown, MD

Jun 2022 - Nov 2023

- Maintained and secured local and cloud network infrastructure, ensuring high availability for marketing platforms and client applications
- Provided technical support and implemented network security measures including firewall configurations, intrusion detection, and patch management
- Collaborated across teams to support remote access, document recurring issues, and ensure reliable network performance during digital campaigns

EDUCATION

George Mason University

2023 - Present (Expected 2027)

B.S., Cybersecurity Engineering

Northern Virginia Community College

C.S.C., Information Systems Technology: Network Engineering (Specialist)

Relevant coursework: Computing Digital Systems Engineering, Computer Programming for Engineers, Systems Engineering Principles, Computer Networking, Operating Systems, Secure RF Communications, Digital Electronics

PROJECTS & CTFS

HackFax x PatriotHacks - Web Attack CTF Lead

2026

Worked with a team of 11 over 6 months to create 30 challenges for the Web Attack category. Challenges incorporated OSINT, Networking, and elements from various security categories.

HackFax - Web Attack CTF Developer

2025

Developed challenges for the Web Attack category that allowed users to exploit vulnerabilities of web elements and manipulate sites to extract information.

HackFax - Participant

2024

Solved and captured the flag for 50 challenges across categories including OSINT, Cyber Principles, and Web Attacks.

PatriotHacks - Participant

2023

Built a Tableau and AWS application matching student majors with career interests. Developed and deployed the product within 72 hours alongside a small team.

ACCOMPLISHMENTS

- Eagle Scout, Boy Scouts of America, Troop 761
- MATA Cybersecurity Leader
- President, AWS GMU
- President, Cybersecurity GMU